# NICHOLLS STATE UNIVERSITY

## HUMAN SUBJECTS INSTITUTIONAL REVIEW BOARD

## REQUEST FOR NON-EXEMPT REVIEW BY HUMAN SUBJECTS INSTITUTIONAL REVIEW BOARD

Nicholls State University has established standards and guidelines to ensure adequate protection is provided to individuals participating in a research activity. The Human Subjects Institutional Review Board (HSIRB) is charged with the responsibility of screening all research which employs human participants conducted by faculty, administrators, or students affiliated with Nicholls State University. The guidelines employed for screening are those set forth by university policy. Please fill in all requested information and return two copies of this form and any supporting documentation to the HSIRB chair or your college HSIRB representative.

**Procedure:**

1. The primary investigator (Referred to as the "applicant") planning a research activity involving human subjects, should obtain a Request for HSIRB application form from the college HSIRB representative or HSIRB Chairperson. Research originating from other institutions should be approved by the host institution prior to applying for approval at Nicholls State University.

2. The Applicant should submit two copies of the completed forms to the college HSIRB representative. An initial review of the application will be made by the college HSIRB representative to determine if the project is considered Category I, EXEMPT, Category II, EXPEDITED REVIEW, or Category III, FULL COMMITTEE REVIEW. If the determination of the college HSIRB representative is that the application warrants an EXEMPT or EXPEDITED REVIEW determination, the Applicant may begin the research project. If the College HSIRB representative determines that the proposed research requires a FULL COMMITTEE REVIEW, the Applicant will be requested to submit ten copies of the application to the HSIRB Chairperson. The college HSIRB representative may not disapprove an application. Disapproval of proposed research involving human subjects may only be determined by the full HSIRB.

3. Applications may be submitted to the college HSIRB representative at any time, however, applications which will require a review by the full HSIRB must be submitted to the Chairperson of the HSIRB by the 20th of each month.

4. In cases where a full review of the application is required, the Applicant may be asked to discuss the proposed research at the meeting of the HSIRB.

**NICHOLLS STATE UNIVERSITY**

**HUMAN SUBJECTS INSTITUTIONAL REVIEW BOARD**

**REQUEST FOR REVIEW BY HUMAN SUBJECTS INSTITUTIONAL REVIEW BOARD**

Title of investigation: A Study in Decision Making

Name of primary investigator: Dr. Christopher Castille Phone: 985-449-7015

Faculty supervisor (if required): NA

Address where HSIRB action letter is to be sent: christopher.castille@nicholls.edu OR 150 Powell Hall.

Other investigators involved in the project:

- Mr. Adrien Maught, adrien.maught@nicholls.edu, 985-448-4194
- Mrs. Kaitlin Gravois, kaitlin.gravois@nicholls.edu, 985-448-4187
- Dr. Ann-Marie R. Castille, ann-marie.castille@nicholls.edu, 985-448-4738

*Please note that this study is one sponsored by the Advancement of Replications Initiative in Management (ARIM; see arimweb.org), of which Dr. Christopher Castille is a Executive Team Member. This initiative uses replication–focused research to help doctoral students learn skills that help them to practice scientific research. Mrs. Kaitlin Gravois and Mr. Adrien Maught are pursuing doctoral degrees in a business discipline. Drs. Castille and Castille are supporting these junior scholars in their work. Most of the design of this study has been developed via Dr. Christopher Castille building off of a focal study published in the literature (cited below); hence why he is listed as the PI on this HS IRB form.*

**This study will be conducted at multiple sites. At those sites with an IRB equivalent, researchers will be required to submit their own IRB application for approval and their respective IRBs will be responsible for the oversight of the data collection at those location(s). A copy of their approved IRB letter and application packet will be forwarded to the Nicholls HSIRB Chair for information purposes only.**

**Universities without an IRB will fall under this IRB application. Researchers at those institutions will be required to complete the CITI Training Program modules on Human Subjects, as required by Nicholls, at their own expense. A request to amend this application by adding additional investigators and institutions will be made as needed.**

Estimated starting date: Fall 2024 Estimated completion date: Spring 2025

Date Submitted to the NSU HSIRB: Tuesday, July 16, 2024

Source of project funds: Nicholls State University Research Council

Is this project a continuation of research previously approved by the HSIRB? No

**(Attach additional pages as necessary)**

## 1. Brief Description of Project Goals: (Attach proposal if applicable)

We have one main goal with this proposal: to examine whether findings from Schweitzer, Ordóñez, and Douma (2004) – a highly-influential publication in the management discipline (over 900 as of our writing) – replicate to another setting. Schweitzer et al. studied whether goal setting – specifically assigning individuals a specific, difficult goal – motivates individuals to engage in unethical behavior. Specifically, the unethical behavior that Schweitzer et al. examined was overstating one's performance on a cognitive task (i.e., a word scrabbling or anagram task). Using a sample of 154 undergraduate students and a classic goal setting task (i.e., an anagram task), they found support for two hypotheses. First, people with specific, unmet goals (e.g., write 9 or more valid words given a set of seven letters) were found to be more likely to overstate their performance than people without specific goals (such as people attempting to 'do their best'). Second, people who fail to reach their goals by a small margin will be more likely to falsely claim to have reached their goals than people who fail to reach their goals by a large margin. Schweitzer et al. also allowed participants in the reward goal condition the opportunity to steal money that was not earned (they could net $2 for meeting an assigned goal when they did not in fact meet this goal). However, only one person took $1 more than what they should have earned.

Specifically, they hypothesized the following.

> *Hypothesis 1. People with specific, unmet goals will be more likely to overstate their performance than people without specific goals (such as people attempting to "do their best").*
>
> *Hypothesis 2. People with unmet reward goals (i.e., goals that are tied to incentives for goal attainment) will be more likely to overstate their performance than people with unmet mere goals.*
>
> *Hypothesis 3. People who fail to reach their goals by a small margin will be more likely to falsely claim to have reached their goals than people who fail to reach their goals by a large margin.*

Schweitzer et al. tested these hypotheses using a between-subjects design with three conditions: (i) 'do your best', (ii) 'mere goal', and (iii) 'reward goal'. The analytical approach taken was an analysis of variance (ANOVA), directional t-tests (independent, paired/dependent), and chi-square tests of significance (alpha = .05).

More details regarding our proposal are available in Appendix A.

**2. Protocol:** Describe the proposed procedures.

Our replication closely mirrors the methodology of Schweitzer et al. (2004). We will use a modified version of an anagram task that has been used frequently in the literature (see Appendix B). We will use a pilot study to identify the 90th percentile of performance and then use this as a goal in the main study. Below, we will describe key details here as they pertain to ensuring participant anonymity. A more detailed description of our procedure (e.g., what is communicated to participants at select parts of our experiment) is available in Appendix C.

In both the main and pilot study, participants will be asked to perform an anagram task (i.e., unscrambling letters into valid words) and given one minute to complete these tasks. However, in the main study, participants will be paid for their time or performance.

When participants consent to participate in our study, they will be randomly assigned a set of materials corresponding to our three experimental conditions: (i) 'do your best', (ii) 'mere goal' (where individuals are given the 90th percentile goal based on pilot testing), and (iii) 'reward goal' (where individuals are given the 90th percentile goal and a $2 reward per round where the goal is attained). All participants will receive an envelope of cash containing $16 dollars to ensure double-blind treatment. No participants will know what condition they are in. This ensures that experimenters do not know what condition a participant is in, further maintaining participant anonymity.

At the beginning of the experiment, the experimenters will orient the participants to the task. There will be a total of 10 rounds (2 are practice and 8 are performance rounds). After the performance rounds, the experimenters will leave the room and give the participants the opportunity to pay themselves (thereby ensuring anonymity at this step). All participants will be asked to check their work and then pay themselves. Participants in the 'do your best' and 'mere goal' conditions will be asked to pay themselves $10. Students in the 'reward goal' condition will be asked to pay themselves based on their performance. Participants will be asked to deposit their materials into one of two boxes before leaving the experiment. The first box will be used to store the booklets containing participants' actual performance and the second box will be used to store the answer sheets and envelopes with remaining cash. Since the materials are assigned randomly while maintaining anonymity, there is no mechanism for tying payment back to participants'. This allows everyone the opportunity to accurately report their performance or overstate their performance, and correspondingly take more cash than is warranted (which are our measures of unethical behavior).

Unbeknownst to the participants, there will be a mechanism for linking the data in the two aforementioned two boxes: the anagram on the eighth round will be unique to the individual's materials but not the individual as a person. This allows overstated performance to be measured as well as whether anyone took more money than was earned. However, the way in which we assign materials and issue payment does not allow participants to be identified, specifically.

After data collection has ended, we will email participants our debriefing form (see Appendix D), disclosing the purpose of our study.

**Data Storage and Management**

For our study, we will be using the Open Science Framework (OSF) for data storage and management. Our repository for our materials (including this IRB) can be found by visiting our OSF repository (https://osf.io/f5u39/?view_only=e457ca87096f4de9a5fa7ae16cc839e7). The OSF is a secure and reputable platform widely used for research data storage and sharing, ensuring compliance with data protection and privacy standards.

Our study involves measurements of unethical behavior; however, we have taken rigorous steps to ensure that all data collected is anonymized. The dataset will not contain any information that could identify individual participants. Each participant will be assigned a unique code that does not link back to their personal identity.

By using the OSF, we will benefit from its secure environment, which includes data encryption and access controls. While only authorized personnel involved in the study will initially have access to the raw data, we plan to share the anonymized dataset broadly with other collaborators and researchers across the globe. This aligns with our commitment to transparency, replicability, and advancing scientific knowledge.

We believe that using the OSF and sharing our data widely will enhance collaboration and contribute to the broader scientific community, while still safeguarding the privacy and confidentiality of our participants.

**3. Risks:** Describe potential or known risks to subjects and precautions that will be taken to minimize them. These includes physical, psychological, and/or sociological risks. Describe how confidentiality will be maintained. Discuss the final disposition of data (what will be done with questionnaires, inventories, videotapes, and/or audio-tapes. Describe provisions to ensure that appropriate facilities and professional attention for health and safety of participants are available and will be utilized.

The research requires participants to complete 10 anagram tasks under different goal setting circumstances: (i) do your best, (ii) mere goal, and (iii) reward goal (see procedures above). There will be an opportunity for participants to overstate how well they performed this task and, from their perspective, to do so without getting caught by the research team. Our methodology allows for anonymous participation. The only evidence that we will maintain that an individual has participated in our study will be from the informed consent form. While our participants' data cannot be linked back to them, unbeknownst to participants, one of the tasks will be a unique identifying code that allows us to link their data across tasks that we can effectively measure unethical behavior (i.e., lying, stealing) without identifying who engaged in this behavior (see procedure above). There is a possibility that this task may be mildly upsetting but no more than what participants would experience in everyday work life. However, psychological support is available if needed. See Nicholls Counseling Center (counseling@nicholls.edu, 985-448-4080).

**4. Benefits:** Describe potential benefits of the research to the individual and/or mankind.

Participants will have the opportunity to receive a small cash reward (approximately $10) for contributing to our research. Specifically, individuals in the ‘do your best’ and ‘mere goal’ conditions will receive $10. Individuals in the ‘reward goal’ condition will only receive $2 for each task where they meet the assigned goal. Participants' data will make an important contribution to scientific research into organizational behavior by providing organizations, managers, and employees with insights so they can better understand how business and social practices influence employee behavior. In this study, participants will be helping us understand the goal setting factors that determine employees’ ethical decision making and how managers can influence employees’ behavior.

**5. Consent Forms:** Please attach a copy of the Regular Form or the Short Form and/or Oral Presentation as supporting documentation to this HSIRB request for review.

See Appendix E.

**6.** a. How will you recruit subjects? **YOU MUST submit <u>VERBATIM COPIES</u>** of all letters, emails, notices, advertisements, etc. and/or all oral presentations to be used to recruit subjects/ participation in the research project (e.g. scripts of direct person-to-person solicitation, telephone solicitation, newspaper solicitation, letters of solicitation, email solicitation, notices of solicitation posted to Facebook or Moodle, etc.).

We will recruit participants by visiting classrooms and sharing the following flier provided by Appendix F (see below).

b. List all criteria for including subjects.

- Undergraduate students
- Working professionals

c. List all criteria for excluding subjects.

Children and other criteria consistent with IRB guidelines.

7. **Describe subject benefits and costs**:

a. Indicate what, if any, benefits may accrue to each of the following: (Payment to research subjects for participation in studies is considered a benefit.)

1) The human subjects involved:
Small cash reward (~$10).

2) Individuals who are not subjects, but who may have similar problems:
Knowledge about whether goal setting practices drive unethical behavior.

3) Society in general:
Knowledge about whether goal setting practices drive unethical behavior.

b. State type, amount, method of disbursement, schedule of payment to be offered, and the effect of withdrawal from participation in the study, if any:
A small cash reward (~$10).

c. Estimated costs to each subject due only to the research participation:

1) Time (i.e., total time commitment for the duration of the project)
1 hour

2) Money
Approximately $10 dollars

3) Is repeated testing required? Explain:
No.

**7. BASIS OF REQUEST FOR EXEMPTION - One of the following (A-E) must be checked.**

_____ A. The research will be conducted only in established or commonly accepted educational settings (like classrooms) **AND** it involves normal educational practices such as research on regular and special educational instructional strategies, or research on the effectiveness of, or the comparison among, instructional techniques, curricula or classroom management methods.

_____ B. It will be conducted using only questionnaire or interview survey methods **AND** the subjects are elected or appointed public officials or candidates for public office.

_____ C. It is limited to the collection and study of existing data, documents, records, pathological or diagnostic specimens which are available to the public.

X____ D. It is limited to the collection and study of data obtained using only the following techniques **AND** the data or information obtained will be recorded in such a manner that subjects cannot be *identified, directly or indirectly*, through identifiers linked with the subjects:

Check the applicable technique(s):

X____ 1. The data will be obtained through the use of educational tests (cognitive, diagnostic, aptitude, achievement, etc.), or

_____ 2. Data will be obtained by observing the public behavior of subjects, or

_____ 3. Data will be obtained using survey or interview procedures, or

_____ 4.Data will be obtained from existing documents, records, pathological or diagnostic specimens.

_____ E. It is limited to the collection and study of data obtained by:

1. Observing the public behavior of the participants, or
2. Using survey or interview procedures, **AND:**

**BOTH OF THE FOLLOWING MUST BE CHECKED IF E-2 IS THE BASIS FOR THE REQUESTED**

**EXEMPTION:**

_____ i) The information collected about the subjects behavior ***does not involve*** sensitive subjects such as illegal or immoral conduct, drug or alcohol use, sexual behavior, mental illness, or other possibly personally embarrassing subjects **AND**,

_____ ii) The information collected about subjects, if it became known to outsiders, could not reasonably be expected to place the subject at risk of civil or criminal liability, or be damaging to the subjects social or financial standing or employability.

## Appendix A – More Detailed Study Goals and Explanation

We have one main goal with this proposal: to examine whether findings from Schweitzer, Ordóñez, and Douma (2004) – a highly-influential publication in the management discipline (over 900 as of our writing) – replicate to another setting. Schweitzer et al. studied whether goal setting – specifically assigning individuals a specific, difficult goal – motivates individuals to engage in unethical behavior. Specifically, the unethical behavior that Schweitzer et al. examined was overstating one's performance on a cognitive task (i.e., a word scrabbling or anagram task). Using a sample of 154 undergraduate students and a classic goal setting task (i.e., an anagram task), they found support for two hypotheses. First, people with specific, unmet goals (e.g., write 9 or more valid words given a set of seven letters) were found to be more likely to overstate their performance than people without specific goals (such as people attempting to 'do their best'). Second, people who fail to reach their goals by a small margin will be more likely to falsely claim to have reached their goals than people who fail to reach their goals by a large margin. Schweitzer et al. also allowed participants in the reward goal condition the opportunity to steal money that was not earned (they could net $2 for meeting an assigned goal when they did not in fact meet this goal). However, only one person took $1 more than what they should have earned.

Schweitzer et al. effectively initiated what has become known as the dark side of goal setting research program (e.g., Welsh & Ordóñez, 2014; Welsh, Baer, Sessions, & Garud, 2020; Welsh, Bush, Thiel, & Bonner, 2019) (for a review, see Latham & Itzchakov, in press). These studies examined the role of other psychological factors, such as moral disengagement, ethical priming, and learning goals on ethical behavior. Collectively, these studies called into question the utility of goal setting interventions – widely considered one of the most effective management tactics available (Locke & Latham, 2002; Miner, 2003) – by suggesting that goal setting can come with 'side effects' in the form of unethical behavior (see Ordóñez et al., 2009). Although there are studies that build on Schweitzer et al.'s claims, to our knowledge a direct replication, defined as one where the same population, measure, and design are used (see Lebel et al., 2018; Dau et al., 2022), has not been conducted. One is needed because many of the effects reported by Schweitzer et al. are underpowered; that is, the probability of rejecting a false null hypothesis is below the conventional 80% threshold. They are also limited to a unique population, specifically undergraduate students at a prestigious university.

Below, we briefly explain the author's logic for the connection between goal setting and unethical behavior, list their specific hypotheses, and further explain why we believe that a replication is needed.

Drawing on goal setting theory, social cognitive theory, and behavioral ethics theory, Schweitzer et al. argue that attaining goals has psychological benefits, even if this goal is obtained unethically (i.e., overstating one's performance to claim that one has met a goal). If the benefits of unethical behavior (i.e., claiming to meet a goal when you fall just shy of meeting it) are greater than the costs of engaging in unethical behavior (e.g., the likelihood of getting caught is very low), then individuals will be more inclined to engage in unethical behavior (e.g., stating that they met a goal when they did not, taking more money than is warranted). For instance, just missing a goal causes an individual to engage in counterfactual reasoning (i.e., imagining that they had met the goal if they had put in more effort or were just a little more capable) (see

Schweitzer et al., 2004). People can easily make themselves feel better by overstating their performance. Specifically, they hypothesized the following.

> *Hypothesis 1. People with specific, unmet goals will be more likely to overstate their performance than people without specific goals (such as people attempting to "do their best").*
>
> *Hypothesis 2. People with unmet reward goals (i.e., goals that are tied to incentives for goal attainment) will be more likely to overstate their performance than people with unmet mere goals.*
>
> *Hypothesis 3. People who fail to reach their goals by a small margin will be more likely to falsely claim to have reached their goals than people who fail to reach their goals by a large margin.*

Schweitzer et al. tested these hypotheses using a between-subjects design with three conditions: (i) 'do your best', (ii) 'mere goal', and (iii) 'reward goal'. The analytical approach taken was an analysis of variance (ANOVA), directional t-tests (independent, paired/dependent), and chi-square tests of significance (alpha = .05). Unfortunately, as we noted earlier, like most studies in the published literature (see Bliese & Wang, 2020; Maxwell & Kelley, 2011; Murphy, 2010), several findings that they report are empirically underpowered. Underpowered findings are those that are unlikely to be replicated under similar circumstances and so their evidence should be treated more tentatively (Bliese & Wang, 2020). Specifically, only two t-test results – that given for Hypotheses 1 and 3 – were large enough (i.e., greater than 2.81, see Bliese & Wang, 2020) to support hypotheses 1 and 3 (the others fell below this criterion). Several other t-values presented by Schweitzer et al. fell below this cutoff.

We submit that there is still so much to learn about unethical behavior from the approach advanced by Schweitzer et al. For instance, although the authors provided descriptive statistics concerning performance, goal attainment, and overstating behavior emerging from their study, they did not provide any descriptive statistics (means, variances, covariances) in regard to the focal study variables (i.e., over-stating, under-stating, demographics, experimental conditions, goal commitment). These are important contributions as they facilitate independent reproductions and replications of prior work, helping us to build a more cumulative science of ethical behavior. Additionally, the absence of such descriptives preclude transparent summary work (i.e., meta-analytic) that is useful for behavioral scientists studying unethical behavior as well as practitioners hoping to use goal setting to boost performance but mitigate against the alleged side effects. For instance, knowing whether goal setting gives rise to unethical behavior as well as how to mitigate against it without harming the performance-enhancing has great practical benefit (see Latham & Itzchakov, in press).

As such, we aim to replicate the results of Schweitzer et al. using a larger sample of students sampled across multiple sites, a recommendation made in the literature to address concerns over lack of resources and underpowered research (see Maxwell & Kelley, 2011). We have recruited over 10 teams of scholars and their doctoral students across 10 different university settings (e.g., Nicholls State University, University of Waterloo, Otto Beisheim School of Management, UC

Louvian, Florida Atlantic University, Radbound University, Durham University Business School) to pool resources and examine the replicability of the dark side of goal setting. At present, this gives us an estimated sample size of approximately 1000 participants, enabling us to detect moderate effect sizes reliably. As we are still recruiting schools, we will include these scholars and their institutional affiliations in an amendment to our protocols later before data collection begins. The target for data collection is the academic year 2024-2025.

## References


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## Appendix B – Anagram Task Materials, Goal Commitment Measure, Demographics, and Answer Sheet

The materials below are adapted from reading Schweitzer et al. (2004). To save space, we include notes clarifying how these materials will vary at least two conditions: (i) Do Your Best and (ii) Reward Goal.

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## Practice Round

You will be given one minute to create as many words as you can.

**Trial Round # 1**

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**Trial Round # 2**

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**Do Your Best**

**Directions**. Your task is to create as many valid English words as possible within **one minute** using the letters provided. The timer on the projector will help you manage your time.

**Rules:**

1. Each word must be at least two letters long.
2. No proper nouns (e.g., Larry, Mexico, Boston Red Sox).
3. Use each of the 7 letters only once per word.
4. Words can only be used in one form.

**Goal:** Do your best to create as many words as you can.

**Payment**: You will earn $10.

**Goal Commitment**
Please respond using the scale provided:

| 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Not at all | Slightly | Moderately | Quite a bit | Extremely |

1. ____ How committed are you to this goal?
2. ____ To what extent do you care about this goal?
3. ____ How dedicated are you to this goal?
4. ____ To what extent have you chosen to be committed to this goal?

After completing the above, look to the instructor. They will notify you when to begin.

## Mere Goal

**Directions**. Your task is to create as many valid English words as possible within **one minute** using the letters provided. The timer on the projector will help you manage your time.

**Rules:**

1. Each word must be at least two letters long.
2. No proper nouns (e.g., Larry, Mexico, Boston Red Sox).
3. Use each of the 7 letters only once per word.
4. Words can only be used in one form.

**Goal:** It is important that you commit to a specific yet attainable goal. *Your goal is to create* ____ during the allotted 1 minute using the seven provided letters on each sheet. This goal is difficult, but realistic. In previous studies many students were able to create ____ or more words per round using the same groups of letters you are about to see.

**Payment**: You will earn $10.

**Goal Commitment**
Please respond using the scale provided:

| 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Not at all | Slightly | Moderately | Quite a bit | Extremely |

5. ____ How committed are you to this goal?
6. ____ To what extent do you care about this goal?
7. ____ How dedicated are you to this goal?
8. ____ To what extent have you chosen to be committed to this goal?

After completing the above, look to the instructor. They will notify you when to begin.

## Reward Goal

**Directions**. Your task is to create as many valid English words as possible within **one minute** using the letters provided. The timer on the projector will help you manage your time.

**Rules:**

5. Each word must be at least two letters long.
6. No proper nouns (e.g., Larry, Mexico, Boston Red Sox).
7. Use each of the 7 letters only once per word.
8. Words can only be used in one form.

**Goal:** It is important that you commit to a specific yet attainable goal. *Your goal is to create* ____ during the allotted 1 minute using the seven provided letters on each sheet. This goal is difficult, but realistic. In previous studies many students were able to create ____ or more words per round using the same groups of letters you are about to see.

**Reward**: You will earn $2 for each round in which a goal is met.

**Goal Commitment**
Please respond using the scale provided:

| 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Not at all | Slightly | Moderately | Quite a bit | Extremely |

9. ____ How committed are you to this goal?
10. ____ To what extent do you care about this goal?
11. ____ How dedicated are you to this goal?
12. ____ To what extent have you chosen to be committed to this goal?

After completing the above, look to the instructor. They will notify you when to begin.

**Round #1**

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**Round #3**

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**Round #4**

EASCKIY

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**Round #5**

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**Round #6**

OELHMAZ

**Round #7**

OASFKEV

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**Round #8**

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**Answer Sheet for 'Do Your Best' and 'Mere Goal'**

Please check your work using the approved resource. For each ANAGRAM, check a box indicating whether or not you created _____ or more valid words. Again, the rules for determining whether a word is 'valid' are**:**

1. Each word must be at least two letters long.
2. No proper nouns (e.g., Larry, Mexico, Boston Red Sox).
3. Use each of the 7 letters only once per word.
4. Words can only be used in one form.

| **ANAGRAM** | **DID NOT MEET GOAL** | **MET GOAL** |
|---|---|---|
| 1. AEDBKUG | | |
| 2. OELBJAM | | |
| 3. UADQWER | | |
| 4. EASCKIY | | |
| 5. OADMHUP | | |
| 6. OELHMAZ | | |
| 7. OASFKEV | | |
| 8. _____ | | |

**Payment:** In the envelope we provided to you at the beginning of this experiment are $1 bills. Please pay yourself **$10** for completing this study.

**Answer Sheet for 'Reward Goal'**

Please check your work using the approved resource. For each ANAGRAM, check a box indicating whether or not you created _____ or more valid words. Again, the rules for determining whether a word is 'valid' are**:**

1. Each word must be at least two letters long.
2. No proper nouns (e.g., Larry, Mexico, Boston Red Sox).
3. Use each of the 7 letters only once per word.
4. Words can only be used in one form.

| **ANAGRAM** | **DID NOT MEET GOAL** | **MET GOAL** |
|---|---|---|
| 1. AEDBKUG | | |
| 2. OELBJAM | | |
| 3. UADQWER | | |
| 4. EASCKIY | | |
| 5. OADMHUP | | |
| 6. OELHMAZ | | |
| 7. OASFKEV | | |
| 8. _____ | | |

**Payment:** In the envelope we provided to you at the beginning of this experiment are $1 bills. Please pay yourself **$2** for each met goal. Afterward, deposit this envelope along with this answer sheet into the box designated by the experimenters.

**Demographics (Included with the Workbook)**

What is your age? _____

What is your sex?

A. Male
B. Female
C. Other

Ethnic origin refers to the ethnic or cultural origins of one's ancestors. An ancestor is usually more distant than a grandparent. Please select the option(s) that best describe your ethnic origin:

A. North American origins (Indigenous, First Nations, Inuit, Metis, and others)
B. European origins
C. Caribbean origins
D. Latin, Central and/or South American origins
E. African origins
F. Asian origins
G. Oceanian origins
H. Prefer to specify _____

What is your first language? _____

## Appendix C – More Details on the Study Procedure

***Pilot Study.*** Per best practice in goal setting research (Locke & Latham, 1990), Schweitzer et al. used a pilot study to identify the 90th percentile performance goal. These participants were given one minute to create words using seven letters listed at the top of a page. The first page of the experimental instructions contained the following rules:

> Each word must be an English word, two or more letters long, other than a proper noun, name by using each of the 7 letters only once per word, and used in only one form.

The pilot participants will perform this task nine times with different combinations of letters. These results will be used to identify the performance goal, which (following prior work) is set to the 90$^{th}$ percentile of performance. Schweitzer et al. selected a goal of creating nine words. Undergraduate participants were then recruited from classes via announcements and flyers. We will follow Schweitzer et al. Individuals will be encouraged to participate in a study on decision making (see Appendix B below).

***Main Study Procedures.*** The following procedures are to be executed in the fall of 2024 and spring 2025**.** Much of the below content is adapted from Schweitzer et al. (2004). However, we will note deviations from Schweitzer et al. and why they are made.

When participants arrive at the experimental location, they will be greeted by the experimenter. The experimenter will issue the informed consent form (see Appendix C) and ask that the participant reads and signs the form if they consent to undergoing study. The consent form will be used to give students credit (e.g., bonus) for participating in our study should that be a request. However, this consent form is not tied to the materials that they are assigned, allowing complete anonymity.

Deviating from Schweitzer et al., participants will then be asked to leave their at the front of the room to minimize distraction. They may keep their phone for the time being (it will be used briefly) but will be asked to place this at the front of the room as well. They will then be asked to take a seat with their materials so that they can work privately and without interruption. Participants will be separated from each other by one or more chairs or other dividers to avoid being distracted or disrupted by others.

Once everyone is seated, the experimenter will verbally note the following:

> Welcome and thank you for participating in our decision making experiment. As a reminder, your participation in this decision making study is strictly voluntary. Any data from your performance in this setting will be held anonymously. You do not have to answer any specific question or questions if you like and you may terminate your participation in our study at any time without penalty. We will ask you to report your age, gender, ethnicity, and whether you speak English as a first language at the end of the study. However, this will not be used to identify you. Please do not put your name or any other identifying information on any workbooks or answer sheets throughout the study.

Following Schweitzer et al. (2004), the participants will be reminded throughout the presentation not to put any identifying information on the workbooks or answer sheets.

After this brief introduction, each participant will then be given a set of materials corresponding to the goal conditions that we are studying: (i) 'do your best' goal, (ii) 'mere goal', and (iii) 'reward goal'. This step (randomly assigning materials to participants) adds another layer of protection as the experimenters will not be able to determine which condition a participant was assigned based on their materials (i.e., the trial will be a double-blind trial). They will also be given two color pens; a blue pen for the first phase of the study and black pen for the second phase of the study. This two pen approach prevents participants from adding words after a 1-minute trial has concluded (Gino & Pierce, 2009). After all participants have entered the room, the experimenter note the following:

> Please take your time as you go through the decision making experiment. Read all instructions very carefully and refrain from talking with or disrupting others for the entire duration of the study.

The experimenter will press play on a powerpoint presentation, which presents a timer that allows the experimental trials to be administered consistently.

Following Schweitzer et al. (2004), once the trial begins, the participants will be asked to do the same word creation task as the pilot participants using the black pen. Afterward, they will be asked to check all of their work using a blue pen at the end of the experiment. The experiment will begin with two practice rounds where they will first use the blue pen. For each practice round, participants will be given one minute and asked to "create as many words as you can." After the practice rounds are completed, they will be given a chance to check their work using an online Scrabble dictionary (https://scrabble.merriam.com) and to scratch out any words that do not fit our rules. Before they begin the performance rounds, they will be asked to return their phones to the front of the class with their personal materials and return to their desk. After being oriented to the task, participants will be asked to complete eight experimental rounds. For each round, they will be given seven letters and one minute to create words. After the last experimental round, participants will complete a final round containing a unique set of letters. Unbeknownst to the participants, this final round contains the mechanism that allows each participant's data to be linked back to their answer sheets and personality assessments: a unique anagram.

Following the practice rounds and before the experimental rounds, the participants will receive their condition-specific instructions (see Appendix A). In the 'do your best' condition, participants are simply told to 'do your best to create as many words as you can' on the following experimental rounds. In the 'mere goal' condition, participants are assigned a goal of creating a number of words that is identified in the pilot study as representing a specific, high goal. The specific instruction are:

> It is important that you commit to a specific yet attainable goal. *Your goal is to create ___words* during the allotted 1 minute using these 7 letters.[1] This goal is difficult, but realistic. In previous studies, many students were able to create ____ or more words per round using the same groups of letters you are about to see.

We will assign the specific goal and fill the blank after we conduct our pilot study. Below, a ____ will be used to signify a specific, high goal.
In the 'reward goal' condition, participants are assigned the same goal and instructions as the 'mere goal' condition but are also told that they will earn two dollars for each round in which the assigned goal is met.

In Schweitzer et al. (2004), all participants were given cash at the start of the study. Participants in the 'do your best' and 'mere goal' conditions were paid $10 at the beginning of the study. Participants in the reward goal condition, who were given an envelope of cash at the beginning of the study, were told that they can keep two dollars for each of the experimental rounds in which they met the goal and then return any unearned money in their envelopes with their answer sheets.

We deviate from Schweitzer et al. thusly. In our study, we will give all participants the same amount of cash in an envelope at the start of the study. This change was made for 3 reasons First, giving participants cash at the beginning of the trial (per Schweitzer et al.) may compromise anonymity because experimenters would know that a participant is not in the 'reward goal' condition. Second, treating all participants equally (i.e., giving everyone an envelope of cash at the start of the study) enables us to process a larger number of students with greater anonymity (i.e., beyond the 20-per-room used by Schweitzer et al., 2004). Using the Schweitzer et al. protocol would be more cumbersome as we would have to ensure that everyone is in the same condition in the same group, which also places participants at risk of losing anonymity since experimenters are in the room during the first stage of the experiment. In other words, we can more efficiently execute a double-blind trial. Third, as the materials assigned to participants will ask participants to take only the specified amount for that condition (e.g., $10, pay for performance) at the conclusion of the study, we will be able to study unethical behavior beyond overstating (i.e., stealing), a recommendation made by leaders in the goal setting literature (Latham & Itzchakov, 2024). For these reasons, we believe that our study builds on the design advanced by Schweitzer et al. (2004).

Per Schweitzer et al. (2004), after the practice rounds and before their experimental rounds, we will ask participants how committed they are to the goal. This is defined as an unwillingness to abandon or lower a goal (Campion & Lord, 1982; as cited in Schweitzer et al., 2004). However, the goal commitment measure we will use is not the same measure used by Schweitzer et al, but a more recent version that addresses shortcomings in older measurement approaches (see Klein, Cooper, & Monahan, 2013).

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[1] Please note that the blanks (____) are stand-ins for the 'specific, high goal' (i.e., 'mere goal') that is identified via the pilot study. In Schweitzer et al., they identified this goals as 9 words. Our pilot study may identify 9 words as well (fewer or mote could be used). Please note that 'do your best' participants do not have a goal to reach.

In the second stage of the experiment (after the performance rounds are completed), participants will be asked to check their own work using a Scrabble dictionary available to students if needed.[2] They will also be reminded of the rules for creating words. They will be told to complete the answer sheet in their materials. This answer sheet requires them to check one of two boxes indicating that he or she created the number of valid-or-more words for each round as determined by the pilot study. Participants will be recruited for a one-hour experiment and will be allowed at least 25 minutes to complete this second stage. When they finish, participants will be asked to deposit their workbooks and answer sheets in separate sealed boxes. Their demographic survey, the words they create, and their responses to the pre- and post-round questions will be in the workbooks. Their claims regarding whether or not they had created nine or more words will be in the answer sheets. Unlike Schweitzer et al., all participants will have envelopes where they will be asked to deposit unearned money and their answer sheets in the same box. Specifically, they must place their answer sheet into the envelope of cash and seal the envelope before depositing the envelope in the box. Like Schweitzer et al., experimenters will be in the room during the first stage of the experiment but then leave the room during the second stage of the experiment. The experimenters will also pick up the black pens before they leave the room to prevent students from adding words to their workbooks.

Experimental sessions will be planned such that more than 20 participants are processed at the same time. Participants will be told not to put their names or any identifying information on any workbooks or answer sheets and reminded of this throughout the session. Participants will have anonymity to place their workbooks and answer sheets in separate sealed boxes. This step ensures anonymity and prevents experimenters from tying any misrepresentations occuring during the experiment to specific individuals. In other words, it will not be possible for any experimenter to identify participants via their data alone.

Unbeknownst to participants, the materials will contain a mechanism for matching the results from the workbooks and answers sheets. The letters used in the eighth trial will be unique to each participant. As the letters are unique to each participant and included in both the answer sheet and the workbook, we will be able to match the two sets of responses. Even though we will have the ability to match answer sheets and workbooks, participants will remain anonymous.

Finally, the method of payment will also ensure participants' anonymity. In Schweitzer et al.'s 'do your best' and 'mere goal' conditions, participants received $10 each before the experiment began. In their 'reward goal' condition, participants were given envelopes containing 16 one-dollar bills at the start of the experiment and were informed to pay themselves by taking money from their envelopes depending on the number of trials in which they met the assigned goal. Reward goal participants were asked to return unearned money along with their answer sheets in sealed envelopes and to deposit their sealed envelopes in a sealed box.

Although Schweitzer et al.'s payment was completely unrelated to performance in the 'do your best' and 'mere goal' conditions, administering payment at the beginning of this study as an

[2] We are also considering modifying the slide deck to include a slide noting that participants need to access this online Scrabble dictionary (https://scrabble.merriam.com) using their phones or other web-enabled devices. They will be allowed to retrieve their phones from the front of the room but must do so using a Lockdown browser or equivalent tool that prevents access to other apps.

experimenter gives experimenters knowledge about the condition to which a particular participant may have been assigned ('do your best' or 'mere goal'). This compromises the double-blind nature of the design that we wish to maintain in our replication effort. As such, deviating from Schweitzer et al. we will give all participants $16 in cash in envelopes at the beginning of the study. Participants in the 'do your best' and 'mere goal' conditions are told that $10 is theirs to keep even if they decide to leave our study prematurely. This decision allows us to pay participants in the manner described by Schweitzer et al. as well as create an opportunity to study unethical behavior both beyond 'overstating' one's performance and beyond the 'reward goal' condition only, a point made by other goal setting scholars (Latham & Itzchakov, 2024). The rest of the procedure (i.e., depositing unearned money in sealed envelopes in a box that is separate from their actual performance) is the same as Schweitzer et al.

*Measurement of Unethical Behavior***.** Schweitzer et al. (2004) invoked a sophisticated measurement strategy for capturing unethical behavior that we will replicate. For each participant, their claims are categorized for each round as either: (1) an accurate report of meeting the goal (creating ___ or more words) and claimed to have created ___ or more words, (2) an understatement of productivity (creating ___ or more words but claiming to have created fewer words), (3) an overstatement of productivity (creating fewer than ___ words but claiming to have created ___ or more words, or (4) an accurate report of missing the goal (creating fewer than ___ words and claiming to have created fewer than ___ words).[3] Although participants in the 'do your best' condition are not given an explicit goal, they are given the opportunity to report whether or not they met the goal of ___ words.

Like Schweitzer et al. (2004), our interest is in the relationship between goal failure and unethical behavior and so in the results we focused our attention on overstatements. For each participant, we will compute an overstatement score to represent the fraction of times he or she overstats productivity relative to the number of times he or she missed the goal, which presents the participant with an opportunity to overstate productivity. Scores will range from 1, indicating a participant overstated productivity every time he or she had a chance to do so, to 0, indicating a participant never overstated productivity. To borrow Schweitzer et al.'s example, consider a participant who creates fewer than the target goal number of words in six rounds. If the participant claims to create ___ or more words in six rounds, his or her overstatement score would equal 0.33 (=2/6). To test the directional hypotheses, following Schweitzer et al. we will compare overstatement scores and the percentages of participants who made overstatements across conditions using one-sided tests of significance.

Like Scweitzer et al. (2004), we will also study whether or not individuals stole money from the research team but in a more exploratory manner. Schweitzer et al. only observed one individual taking more money than was earned. As such, we do not have a clear prior basis upon which to measure theft as an unethical behavior in a manner that is as sophisticated as overstating.

***Data Coding Plan***. After data collection has ceased for an experimental session, the experimenters will re-enter the room and gather the boxes. Three experimenters will be assigned with coding the data thusly. First, researcher A will be assigned with coding the booklets (actual

[3] Again, please note that the blanks (____) are stand-ins for the 'specific, high goal' (i.e., 'mere goal') that is identified via the pilot study. Please note that 'do your best' participants do not have a goal to reach.

performance, goal commitment, demographics) and researcher B will be assigned with coding the amount of money withdrawn and self-rated performance. Both will code the data for the corresponding condition. Second, these experimenters will share their Excel files with researcher C (Dr. Christopher Castille). Third, research C will (i) bind together the two datasets created by researchers A and B using the unique anagram in their dataset and (ii) replace the unique identifying code (i.e., anagram) with a different unique identifying code. By breaking up the coding in this manner, researcher A and B cannot identify a particular participant by looking at the dataset that researcher C creates.

***Debriefing Plan***. After all data has been collected (approximate end date is late-Fall 2024 and Spring 2025), we will email all participants our debriefing form (see Appendix D below). This is done to minimize diffusion of treatment, disclose the purpose of our study, and provide participants with the appropriate resources should they need counseling.

## References


Gino, F., & Pierce, L. (2009). The abundance effect: Unethical behavior in the presence of wealth. *Organizational Behavior and Human Decision Processes*, *109*(2), 142–155. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.obhdp.2009.03.003

Klein, H., Cooper, J., & Monahan, C. (2013). Goal commitment. In E. A. Locke & G. P. Latham (Eds.), *New Developments in Goal Setting and Task Performance* (pp. 65–89). Routledge.

Locke, E. A., & Latham, G. P. (1990). *A theory of goal setting & task performance.* Prentice-Hall, Inc.

Schweitzer, M. E., Ordóñez, L., & Douma, B. (2004). Goal Setting as a Motivator of Unethical Behavior. *Academy of Management Journal*, *47*(3), 422–432.

## Appendix D – Debriefing Materials

We appreciate your participation in our study and thank you for spending the time helping us with our research. The purpose of this post-study information page is to provide additional details about the study you just participated in.

You were originally told that this study was designed to allow us to study decision making behavior. While we were indeed interested in studying decision making behavior, the study objectives were more involved than what was originally explained to you. As part of this study, you were given specific instructions for the decision making task. For example, you may have been told to create as many words as possible, to create a specific number of words or more, or to create a specific number of words or more and receive payment for meeting or exceeding the goal. We were interested in examining how these instructions influenced your performance on the task and the number of words you reported. Unbeknownst to you, we did have a mechanism for identifying whether or not participants did the following: (i) overstated their performance and (ii) took more money than was warranted. However, this mechanism does not allow us to identify whether you specifically overstated your performance or took more money than was deserved. The data that you provided to us in this study allows for complete anonymity. We cannot identify your data even if requested because we have no mechanism for linking your data back to you. Lastly, we must note that although our data will be shared so other scholars can build upon our work, sharing the data that we've gathered does not allow anyone to be identified from the summarized results.

The full purpose of this study could not be revealed to you initially as doing so could have possibly influenced your responses. We hope you understand why we could not fully disclose the purpose of the study earlier. If you have questions about the study or the procedures or experience adverse effects as a result of participating in this study, you may contact the lead researcher, Dr. Christopher Castille (christopher.castille@nicholls.edu). We also encourage you to contact the Counseling Center at Nicholls State University (https://www.nicholls.edu/counseling/) if you experience any adverse effects based on your participation in this study. You can also call (985) 448-4080.

This study has been reviewed and received ethics clearance through the Institutional Review Board at the Nicholls State University (IRB####).

To gather information or learn more about the topic of study, we invite you to visit the website for this particular project. This project was sponsored by a large consortium of management researchers, the *Advancement of Replications Initiative in Management* (ARIM), of which Dr. Christopher Castille is a project coordinator. Please see this website for details (https://www.arimweb.org/replications-initiative/s1-the-dark-side-of-goal-setting).

Thank you very much for your assistance. We sincerely hope you enjoyed participating in this study.

**3. Risks:** Describe potential or known risks to subjects and precautions that will be taken to minimize them. These includes physical, psychological, and/or sociological risks. Describe how confidentiality will be maintained. Discuss the final disposition of data (what will be done with questionnaires, inventories, videotapes, and/or audio-tapes). Describe provisions to ensure that appropriate facilities and professional attention for health and safety of participants are available and will be utilized.

*Short-term and long-term risks.* These are expected to be minimal. There is a possibility that this task may be mildly upsetting but no more than what one would experience in everyday life. However, psychological support will be available if needed. Participants will be told to pursue the Nicholls Counseling Center (counseling@nicholls.edu, 985-448-4080).

All data will be gathered anonymously. The paper copies of the participants' materials will be copied electronically and held on a password-protected computer. The paper files themselves will be held on record for 5-7 years, per guidelines provided by the *American Psychological Association*. A summary dataset containing the raw results will be made available for other scholars to build off of our work. Importantly, no identifying information will be included with the dataset so participants cannot be identified on the basis of these or other materials. More details about our data coding plan are available in our procedure.

## Appendix E – Informed Consent Form for a Study in Decision-Making

**Purpose of the Study**
You are invited to participate in a research study conducted by researchers from the Department of Management and Marketing at Nicholls State University. The purpose of this study is to understand decision-making in work settings. Multiple researchers with different interests and focuses are contributing to a broader understanding of how individuals make decisions. Researchers from Nicholls State University include Ms. Kaitlin Bier, Mr. Adrien Maught, Dr. Ann-Marie Castille, and Dr. Christopher Castille. A small grant from Nicholls State University was used to fund this research.

**What will you do in this study?**
In this study, you will work on a decision making task. You will also be asked to fill out surveys that measure your attitudes about the task and basic demographic information. You will be able to skip any question or task that makes you feel uncomfortable. Participation in this study will take a total of 1 hour. We cannot reveal all the elements involved in this study right now because doing so may influence how you will respond. However, we will reveal to you all elements of the study once the data collection is complete.

**Risks**
The research requires you to complete a decision making task. There is a possibility that this task may be mildly upsetting but no more than what you would experience in everyday life. If you find that you are upset by the task posed in this research, please stop immediately. In case you feel you need additional support, there are resources available. This stress is not expected to last beyond the end of the study session. However, psychological support is available if needed. See Nicholls Counseling Center (counseling@nicholls.edu, 985-448-4080).

**Benefits**
The researchers cannot guarantee any direct benefits from participation. However, an important contribution of scientific research into organizational behavior is to provide organizations, managers, and employees with data so they can better understand how business and social practices influence employee behavior. In this study, you will be helping us understand the factors that determine employees' decision making and how managers can influence employees' behavior.

**Confidentiality of Your Information**
Approximately 500 students from Nicholls State University will be asked to complete this study. Your anonymity is crucial to the success of this study. Please do not put any identifying information on your materials. We do not wish to gather any names or have any of your identifying information associated with any of the data that is collected. All data collected will be anonymous. No information that would potentially identify a participant or organization will be used in the analyses and/or results. Furthermore, because the interest of this study is in the average responses of the entire group of participants, you will not be identified individually in any way in any written reports of this research. Any raw data will be kept for a period of at least 7 years following publication of the research. The data will be stored on secure Nicholls State University

servers or, as needed, on encrypted external drives and only researchers associated with this study have access. De-identified data related to your participation may be submitted to an online repository and/or journal (i.e., the data may be publicly available). These data will be completely anonymized prior to submission and will be presented in aggregate form in publications. This process is integral to the research process as it allows other researchers to verify results and avoid duplicating research. Though the data is posted for the purpose listed, other individuals may access these data by accessing the open access repository. Although the dataset without identifiers may be shared publicly, your identity will always remain confidential. Should you not wish to submit your data in this manner, please do not select this study.

**Remuneration**
You will receive compensation in the form of a small cash reward.

**Contact**
This project has been reviewed and received clearance from the Institutional Review Board at Nicholls State University (_____). If you feel you have not been treated according to the descriptions in this form or your rights as a participant in research have been violated during the course of this project, you may contact the Nicholls State University Institutional Review Board _____. If you have questions at any time about the study or the procedures, you may contact the researchers by emailing Mrs. Kaitlin Bier at kaitlin.gravois@nicholls.edu. However, you should be aware that if you email the researchers from a personal email address, your identity may become known.

**Participation**
Your participation in this study is voluntary. If you decide to participate, you may withdraw from the study at any time without penalty and without loss of benefits to which you are otherwise entitled. If you withdraw from the study before data collection is completed, you will receive your compensation. Please notify the team that you have withdrawn from the study and your data will be destroyed. You have the right to skip any question(s)/procedure(s) you choose. Note that a withdrawal from the study will not affect participants' relationship with the researchers or Nicholls State University.

**Feedback and Publication**
The results of the study will be submitted to peer-reviewed academic journals for publication consideration and/or be presented at a conference. If you would like a copy of the results, please make this request to the research team (Mrs. Kaitlin Bier, kaitlin.gravois@nicholls.edu).

**CONSENT**
You are making a decision whether to participate in this study. Your signature below indicates that you have read this form (or the form was read to you) and that all questions have been answered to your satisfaction. By signing this consent form, you are not waiving any of your legal rights as a research participant. A copy of this consent form will be provided to you.

I agree to participate in this study.

| _____ | _____ | _____ |
|---|---|---|
| **Name of Adult Participant** | **Signature of Adult Participant** | **Date** |

_____

**Email Address**

## Appendix F – Marketing

Al Danos
College of Business Administration

Nicholls State University

### A Study in Decision Making

You are invited to participate in a research study ("Examining Decision Making"). This study has received ethics clearance from the Institutional Review Board at Nicholls State University (_____). The study is being conducted by Ms. Kaitlin Bier, Mr. Adrien Maught, Dr. Ann-Marie Castille, and Dr. Christopher Castille. A small grant from Nicholls State University was used to fund this research.

All students at Nicholls State University are eligible to participate. If you agree to participate in this study, you will be asked to complete a decision making task at a data and time that is assigned to you. You will also be asked to complete a series of measures related to your personality, attitudes, and feelings as well as some demographics. This will take approximately 1 hour to complete.

Approximately 500 students at Nicholls State University will be asked to complete this study. You will not be asked to identify yourself and the information will be anonymous. To protect your anonymity, you will not be asked to provide your name, email address, or other potentially identifying information.

You may contact Ms. Kaitlin Bier (kaitlin.bier@nicholls.edu) if you have any questions or concerns about this study.

CITI PROGRAM

Completion Date 11-Jul-2024
Expiration Date 11-Jul-2026
Record ID 59381573

This is to certify that:

**Ann-Marie Castille**

Not valid for renewal of certification through CME.

Has completed the following CITI Program course:

**Human Subjects Research**
(Curriculum Group)
**Faculty Researchers and Research Sponsors**
(Course Learner Group)
**1 - Basic Course**
(Stage)

Under requirements set by:

**Nicholls State University**

CITI
Collaborative Institutional Training Initiative

101 NE 3rd Avenue, Suite 320
Fort Lauderdale, FL 33301 US
www.citiprogram.org

Generated on 11-Jul-2024. Verify at www.citiprogram.org/verify/?w6503c32a-8e0f-4358-be17-d990c1207992-59381573

CITI PROGRAM

Completion Date 22-Oct-2023
Expiration Date 22-Oct-2025
Record ID 59225119

This is to certify that:

**Kaitlin Gravois**

Not valid for renewal of certification through CME.

Has completed the following CITI Program course:

**Human Subjects Research**
(Curriculum Group)
**Faculty Researchers and Research Sponsors**
(Course Learner Group)
**1 - Basic Course**
(Stage)

Under requirements set by:

**Nicholls State University**

CITI
Collaborative Institutional Training Initiative

101 NE 3rd Avenue, Suite 320
Fort Lauderdale, FL 33301 US
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CITI PROGRAM

| | |
|---|---|
| Completion Date | 22-Jan-2023 |
| Expiration Date | N/A |
| Record ID | 53832757 |

This is to certify that:

**Adrien Maught**

Not valid for renewal of certification through CME.

Has completed the following CITI Program course:

**Social and Behavioral Responsible Conduct of Research Students**
(Curriculum Group)
**Social and Behavioral Responsible Conduct of Research**
(Course Learner Group)
**1 - Basic Course**
(Stage)

Under requirements set by:

**University of South Alabama**

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CITI PROGRAM

Completion Date 10-May-2024
Expiration Date 10-May-2026
Record ID 59381539

This is to certify that:

**Christopher Castille**

Not valid for renewal of certification through CME.

Has completed the following CITI Program course:

**Human Subjects Research**
(Curriculum Group)
**Faculty Researchers and Research Sponsors**
(Course Learner Group)
**1 - Basic Course**
(Stage)

Under requirements set by:

**Nicholls State University**

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